of little Bobby Tables (https://xkcd.com/327) highlights the need to always validate data sent by a user.

Validation isn't used only to check for security threats, though. It's also needed to check for nonmalicious errors:

- *Data should be formatted correctly.* Email fields have a valid email format, for example.
- *Numbers may need to be in a particular range.* You can't buy -1 copies of this book!
- *Some values may be required, but others are optional.* Name may be required for a profile, but phone number is optional.
- *Values must conform to your business requirements.* You can't convert a currency to itself; it needs to be converted to a different currency.

As mentioned earlier, the minimal API framework doesn't include anything specific to help you with these requirements, but you can use filters to implement validation, as you'll see in section 7.10.3. .NET 7 also includes a set of attributes that you can use to simplify your validation code significantly.

7.10.2 Using DataAnnotations attributes for validation

Validation attributes—more precisely, `DataAnnotations` attributes—allow you to specify the rules that your parameters should conform to. They provide metadata about a parameter type by describing the *sort* of data the binding model should contain, as opposed to the data itself.